

SA CRYPTO TAX CHEAT SHEET.

SARS SEES YOUR TRADES.

Since 1 March 2026 (CARF), South African exchanges report your identity and trade totals directly to SARS. Non-disclosure is no longer a strategy. Everything you need to file right — on one page.

THE 5 RULES — 60-SECOND VERSION

- 01 Crypto is a "crypto asset" to SARS — an asset, not a currency. Normal tax rules apply, and they always have.
- 02 Every disposal is a taxable event: selling for rands, swapping coin-to-coin, spending crypto, even gifting it. Not just cashing out.
- 03 Earned crypto is income — mining, staking rewards, airdrops, getting paid in crypto. Taxed at market value on the day you receive it (18–45%).
- 04 Investor or trader? investors pay CGT (max effective 18%); frequent traders pay income tax (up to 45%). Intent + frequency decide.
- 05 Losses count too. Capital losses offset capital gains; unused losses carry forward. Declare them — they save you money later.

INVESTOR VS TRADER

	INVESTOR (CGT)	TRADER (INCOME)
YOU...	buy & hold long-term	flip frequently / for profit-making
TAXED ON	40% of the gain	100% of the profit
MAX RATE	18% effective	45% marginal
TAX-FREE	first R40,000 of gains*	—
ITR12	Capital gains schedule	"Other income" / local business

CARF — WHAT SARS NOW RECEIVES

From 1 Mar 2026, every SA-registered exchange, broker and hosted wallet must report your identity, tax residency, and annual totals of buys, sells and transfers to SARS. First reports reach SARS by 31 May 2027; SARS swaps data with other countries from Sept 2027 — offshore exchanges included.

RECORDS SARS EXPECTS YOU TO KEEP (5 YEARS)

- Every trade: date, asset, amount, ZAR value at the time
- Cost basis per coin (what you paid, incl. fees)

THE CGT MATHS — WORKED EXAMPLE

Bought BTC R100,000
Sold BTC R180,000
Gain R80,000
– annual exclusion –R40,000*
× 40% inclusion = R16,000 → taxable income
× marginal rate (e.g. 36%) = R5,760 tax

* R40,000 = tax year ended 28 Feb 2026 (the return you file this season). Rises to R50,000 from the 2026/27 tax year (Budget 2026).

KEY 2026 DATES

1 MAR 2026	CARF live — exchanges reporting to SARS
~EARLY JUL 2026	Filing season expected to open (watch SARS notice)
31 AUG 2026	1st provisional payment (2027 year) — active traders
~LATE OCT 2026	Expected non-provisional (salaried) filing deadline